

Aithlete — Season Plan & Analysis

Syców 1/2 IM (12 Jul 2026) · Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM) (06 Sep 2026)
Targets: 4:20 1/2 · 9:30 full

Generated 2026-07-07 from 1611 activities (2023-05-21 → 2026-06-25). Plan id goal-2026-malbork. All figures computed from persisted data; physiology values are estimates (provenance tagged), not lab-measured.

280.0 W

FTP (3.89 W/KG)

64.4

CTL (COMBINED)

76.1

ATL

-11.8

TSB (FORM)

95.0 ms

HRV (RMSSD)

37.0 bpm

RESTING HR

1343 h

LOGGED

1 · Base assumptions & method

Goals (athlete-confirmed)

- Syców 1/2 IM** — Sun 12 Jul 2026 — **B-race / tune-up**. Target **4:20**, swim 35-36'.
- Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM)** — Sun 06 Sep 2026 — **A-race**. Target **9:30**, swim ~75'.
- Volume ceiling: **14 h/wk** to first race, **17 h/wk** after.

Equipment

New disc rear wheel on the TT bike (bought pre-2025 Castle). Athlete estimate 20-30 W saved at race speed. At IM power/speed that is ~+1.0-1.3 km/h, i.e. 6-9 min over 180 km (3-5 min over 90 km) or the same speed at lower normalized power — we spend part on speed, part on fresher legs for the run.

Data sources

- Activities, power, pace, load: **intervals.icu** (Garmin-synced), 1611 sessions 2023-05-21→2026-06-25.
- CTL/ATL: intervals.icu wellness where present, else Banister (τ_{42}/τ_7) on local TSS.
- Recovery (HRV/RHR/sleep): wearable wellness.

Models & guardrails

- Load: Banister impulse-response (CTL/ATL/TSB).
- Race detection: triathlons reconstructed from transition activities; classified to nearest IM fraction.
- The plan is gated by a **deterministic validator** (ramp caps, recovery cadence, ACWR, intensity distribution, taper window, race-day TSB). See §8.

Decision-support, not medical or coaching advice. Physiology values are estimates with provenance tags. Validate paces/powers in training and adjust to in-session readiness.

2 · Athlete profile

Physiology (estimated)

METRIC	VALUE	SOURCE
Weight	72.0 kg	intervals.icu wellness
FTP (bike)	280.0 W (3.89 W/kg)	intervals settings
VO2max (bike)	59 ml/kg/min	Firstbeat estimate
Run threshold	3:30/km	intervals.icu sport settings
VO2max (run)	67 ml/kg/min	Firstbeat estimate
LTHR	165.0 bpm	intervals settings
Max HR	182.0 bpm	intervals settings
Swim CSS	1:45–1:48/100m	season spec (pool threshold)
Bike decoupling	2.99 %	Pw:HR

Health / readiness

METRIC	NOW	BASELINE	TREND
HRV rMSSD	95.0	100.6 (7d)	up
Resting HR	37.0	45.0	down
Sleep	7.33 h	—	—

Training load by discipline

SPORT	CTL	ATL	TSB	TREND
combined	64.4	76.1	−11.8	up
swim	4.1	3.3	0.4	flat
bike	28.7	29.7	−4.9	up
run	30.4	37.4	−1.8	up

The headline limiter: swim. Swim CTL 4.1 vs bike 28.7 / run 30.4. Only ~25 h swimming logged in 2026. The swim costs little time on the clock but, untrained, it taxes the whole day. The plan holds **swim ≥ 3x/week** throughout — the single highest-leverage change.

Why the targets are plausible (YoY trajectory)

- Half: 5:50 (2023) -> 4:46 (Sieraków 2026) = -64 min / 3 yr.
- Quarter: 2:51-2:53 (2024) -> 2:18 (Mietków 2026) = -33 min.
- Full: 10:36 (2025) -> target 9:30 = -66 min, in line with trend.

3 · Results history (auto-detected)

DATE	EVENT	FMT	TOTAL	SWIM	BIKE	RUN	NOTES
2023-05-27	—	1/2	5:50:28	38:21	2:55:31	2:04:27	2:01/100m · 30.8 km/h · 5:53/km
2023-08-06	Ironman 70.3 Gdynia	1/2	4:50:46	—	2:53:19	1:57:27	31.2 km/h · 5:33/km
2024-06-08	—	1/4	2:51:07	19:01	1:24:57	1:00:26	2:00/100m · 31.8 km/h · 5:43/km
2024-09-29	—	1/4	2:53:02	19:45	1:28:17	49:26	2:04/100m · 30.6 km/h · 4:41/km
2025-07-13	Garmin Triathlon Tour Syców	1/2	5:02:44	40:05	2:37:24	1:37:51	2:06/100m · 34.3 km/h · 4:38/km
2025-09-07	Castle Triathlon Malbork	full	10:35:52	1:20:08	5:19:29	3:46:48	2:06/100m · 33.8 km/h · 5:22/km
2026-05-30	Sieraków 2026	1/2	4:45:50	35:56	2:30:09	1:28:50	1:53/100m · 36.0 km/h · 4:12/km
2026-06-13	Mietkow	1/4	2:18:07	19:34	1:15:07	38:59	2:03/100m · 35.9 km/h · 3:41/km

T1/T2 not shown; included in totals.

4 · Training history

1611

ACTIVITIES

1343 h

TOTAL TIME

247 h

2026 YTD

10.0 h

AVG LAST 16 WK

16.0 h

PEAK WEEK (16WK)

Volume by discipline (all-time)

SPORT	SESS.	HOURS	KM
workout	488	437	486
run	363	314	3921
bike	154	218	6675
weighttraining	168	136	0
swim	147	74	241
yoga	98	60	0
virtualride	41	49	322
openwaterswim	74	23	46
hike	55	23	89

Last 16 weeks (combined)

WEEK ENDING	H	TSS	#
2026-03-15	11.9	503	14
2026-03-22	9.2	416	11
2026-03-29	12.7	580	15
2026-04-05	9.2	396	11
2026-04-12	8.8	419	11
2026-04-19	10.7	597	12
2026-04-26	10.3	502	10
2026-05-03	9.7	378	12
2026-05-10	8.1	413	8
2026-05-17	16.0	627	14
2026-05-24	7.1	373	8
2026-05-31	11.0	550	14
2026-06-07	6.9	368	8
2026-06-14	9.7	397	13
2026-06-21	12.6	693	11
2026-06-28	5.4	277	6

Demonstrated capacity (last 16 wk peak above) frames the plan's peak weeks as an extension of proven load, not a step into the unknown.

5 · Target race splits

Syców 1/2 IM → 4:20

LEG	TARGET	DETAIL
Swim 1.9 km	36:00	1:54/100m (wetsuit/OW)
T1	2:00	tighten vs 4:28 in Sieraków
Bike 90 km	2:16:00	~39.7 km/h @ 250-262 W (disc/aero)
T2	1:30	tighten vs 6:27 in Sieraków
Run 21.1 km	1:24:30	4:00/km
TOTAL	4:20	

vs Sieraków 2026 (4:45:50): bike -14 min (wheels+fitness), transitions -7 min (T1+T2 were 10:55!), run -4 min, swim flat -> ~-26 min.

Malbork Castle Triathlon (Full IM) → 9:30

LEG	TARGET	DETAIL
Swim 3.8 km	1:15:00	1:58/100m -> your 75' target
T1	3:30	
Bike 180 km	5:02:00	~35.8 km/h @ ~200 W NP (disc/aero)
T2	2:30	
Run 42.2 km	3:07:00	4:26/km
TOTAL	9:30	

vs Malbork 2025 (10:35:52): run -40 min (the big, earned lever), bike -17 min (wheels+pacing), swim -5 min, T -3 min. Stretch 9:20 = bike 4:57 + run 3:01.

Risk ranking. (1) Run durability — the 2025 IM run faded to ~5:22/km; 4:26/km off the bike must be earned with long Z2 runs + race-pace bricks. (2) Swim base — held up by frequency. (3) Bike — the most bankable gain (equipment + position). Spend the wheel watts on a slightly easier bike to protect the run.

6 · Periodization & calendar

WK	START	PHASE	H	TSS	S/B/R	FOCUS
1	2026-06-22	build	11.4	619	2/4/4	Sharpen; honor fixed sessions; re-seat swim 3x
2	2026-06-29	build	12.2	644	3/3/4	Pre-Syców peak: Sat half-IM race-sim brick, Sun long run
3	2026-07-06	taper RACE	8.8	534	3/2/3	Mini-taper -> RACE Syców (Sun)
4	2026-07-13	transition	8.7	409	2/3/3	Post-race reset / aerobic rebuild
5	2026-07-20	build	13.0	631	3/3/3	IM build 1 — volume up, TT-bike aero, intro IM-pace
6	2026-07-27	build	14.3	670	3/3/2	IM build 2 — first 4h+2h race-sim brick, IM-pace bike
7	2026-08-03	build REC	8.2	398	3/3/3	Lighter down-week — cut volume, keep sharpness (not a rest week)
8	2026-08-10	build	15.0	714	3/3/2	IM build 3 — 4h+2h race-sim brick, big IM-pace volume
9	2026-08-17	build	16.0	760	3/3/2	IM peak — biggest week, 4.5h+2h brick at IM pace
10	2026-08-24	taper	9.2	478	3/3/3	Taper 1 — volume down, keep sharpness
11	2026-08-31	taper RACE	13.3	663	3/3/2	Taper 2 -> RACE Malbork (Sun)

S/B/R = swim/bike/run sessions. Recovery weeks drop load ≥40% (derived, not just labelled).

Session detail

Week 1 2026-06-22 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 22.06	Easy spin (completed)	EASY	1:15:00	58	Already logged.
Tue 23.06	Swim (completed)	EASY	45:00	24	Already logged.
Tue 23.06	Run easy (completed)	EASY	45:00	41	Already logged.
Wed 24.06	Z2 ride (completed)	EASY	1:15:00	58	Already logged.
Thu 25.06	Threshold run 4x8' (completed)	MODERATE	58:00	72	As executed: 4x8' threshold (IF 0.90). Replaced the planned 3rd swim.
Thu 25.06	Anaerobic bike (completed)	HARD	1:19:00	116	As executed: 12x25-40s @ ~360-378 W (~130% FTP), sprint/anaerobic-capacity flavor.
Fri 26.06	Z2 brick ride (planned)	EASY	2:00:00	92	As scheduled.
Fri 26.06	Brick run (planned) BRICK	EASY	1:00:00	55	As scheduled, off the bike.
Sat 27.06	Long run (planned)	EASY	1:30:00	82	As scheduled, Saturday AM.
Sat 27.06	Swim easy	EASY	40:00	21	Short aerobic swim, limiter volume.

Week 2 2026-06-29 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 29.06	Swim technique + aerobic	EASY	50:00	27	Drills + 8-12x100 @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus.
Mon 29.06	Strength (lower + core)	EASY	45:00	16	Posterior chain + core; injury prevention.
Tue 30.06	Bike key set	HARD	45:00	66	VO2/threshold sharpener: 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100%.
Wed 01.07	Swim threshold (completed)	MODERATE	35:00	28	As executed: 20x100 on 2:00 avg 1:43/100 (1:37 -> 1:47). CSS re-baselined to 1:45-1:48.
Wed 01.07	Run easy + strides	EASY	40:00	37	Z2 + 6x20s strides.
Thu 02.07	Bike Z2 endurance	EASY	1:15:00	58	Aerobic spin; keep it easy — the quality this week is Tue key + Sat race-sim.
Thu 02.07	Brick run Z2 BRICK	EASY	1:00:00	55	1h Z2 straight off the bike. Strictly easy — protect Saturday's race-sim.
Fri 03.07	Swim aerobic endurance	EASY	1:00:00	32	15x200 on 4:00 @ ~1:50/100 (3:40/200), longer rest each 600m. One block buoy+snorkel, one snorkel-only, last block free full stroke.
Fri 03.07	Mobility / core	EASY	30:00	11	Optional; keep easy.
Sat 04.07	Half-IM race-sim ride	MODERATE	2:35:00	181	TT bike in aero: 2x30' @ 90-95% FTP (~252-266 W = Syców target power), rest Z2. Fuel 70-90g carbs/h.
Sat 04.07	Half-IM pace brick run BRICK	MODERATE	30:00	38	Off the bike @ ~4:00/km = Syców target run pace. The key race rehearsal.
Sun 05.07	Long run (Z2)	EASY	1:45:00	96	Aerobic long run; separate day from the brick. Last 15-20' @ race effort if fresh.

Week 3 2026-07-06 · taper

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 06.07	Swim easy + 4x50 fast	EASY	40:00	21	Openers, stay sharp.
Tue 07.07	Bike openers	MODERATE	1:00:00	70	3x3' @ race power + 3x30s fast.
Tue 07.07	Brick run short BRICK	EASY	20:00	18	10' off bike @ ~4:00/km race pace.
Wed 08.07	Swim race-pace feel	MODERATE	35:00	28	6x100 @ race pace, long rests.
Thu 09.07	Run easy + strides	EASY	35:00	32	4x20s strides; legs snappy.
Fri 10.07	Spin + openers	EASY	40:00	31	Few 30s efforts, otherwise easy.
Sat 11.07	Swim shakeout	EASY	20:00	11	Short, pre-race feel.
Sat 11.07	Shakeout jog	EASY	20:00	18	15-20' easy + 3 strides.
Sun 12.07	RACE: Syców 1/2 IM	RACE	4:20:00	305	Target 4:20. Swim 35-36' / T1 / bike ~2:20 @ 250-265 W / T2 / run ~1:25 @ ~4:00/km.

Week 4 2026-07-13 · transition

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 13.07	Off / walk	EASY	30:00	11	Full recovery day after the race.
Tue 14.07	Swim recovery	EASY	40:00	21	Loosen up, technique only.
Wed 15.07	Easy spin	EASY	1:00:00	46	Z1-2 flush.
Wed 15.07	Run easy	EASY	30:00	28	Short, easy.
Thu 16.07	Swim aerobic	EASY	50:00	27	Back to swim volume.
Fri 17.07	Bike tempo (light)	MODERATE	1:00:00	70	2x15' @ 85-90% FTP; re-engage.
Sat 18.07	Long ride (Z2)	EASY	2:30:00	115	Rebuild aerobic base on TT bike.
Sat 18.07	Brick run BRICK	EASY	25:00	23	Short brick off the ride.
Sun 19.07	Long run (Z2)	EASY	1:15:00	69	Easy aerobic; no intensity.

Week 5 2026-07-20 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 20.07	Swim technique + aerobic	EASY	1:01:40	33	Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.
Mon 20.07	Strength (lower + core)	EASY	55:30	20	Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.
Tue 21.07	Bike key set	HARD	59:12	87	VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP
Wed 22.07	Swim threshold	MODERATE	1:07:50	54	Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.
Wed 22.07	Run easy + strides	EASY	55:30	51	Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.
Thu 23.07	Bike tempo/sweet-spot	MODERATE	1:06:36	78	2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.
Fri 24.07	Swim aerobic endurance	EASY	1:01:40	33	Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.
Fri 24.07	Mobility / core	EASY	37:00	14	Optional; keep easy.
Sat 25.07	Long ride (Z2) + brick	EASY	3:00:00	138	On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 3x20' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed.
Sat 25.07	Brick run off bike BRICK	EASY	45:00	41	First 10' @ IM/half race pace off the bike, then Z2.
Sun 26.07	Long run (Z2)	EASY	1:30:00	82	Aerobic long run; last 15-20' @ race effort when fresh enough.

Week 6 2026-07-27 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 27.07	Swim technique + aerobic	EASY	1:06:03	35	Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.
Mon 27.07	Strength (lower + core)	EASY	59:27	22	Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.
Tue 28.07	Bike key set	MODERATE	1:03:24	74	VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP
Wed 29.07	Swim threshold	MODERATE	1:12:39	58	Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.
Wed 29.07	Run easy + strides	EASY	59:27	54	Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.
Thu 30.07	Bike tempo/sweet-spot	MODERATE	1:11:20	83	2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.
Fri 31.07	Swim aerobic endurance	EASY	1:06:03	35	Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.
Fri 31.07	Mobility / core	EASY	39:38	14	Optional; keep easy.
Sat 01.08	Long ride (Z2) + brick	EASY	4:00:00	184	On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 4x30' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed.
Sat 01.08	Brick run off bike BRICK	EASY	2:00:00	110	IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.

Week 7 2026-08-03 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 03.08	Swim technique + speed	EASY	50:00	27	Drills + 6x50 fast; form + a little snap.
Tue 04.08	Bike sharpener (short)	MODERATE	55:00	64	3x8' @ 90-95% FTP (~250 W). Hold sharpness on low volume.
Wed 05.08	Swim aerobic	EASY	45:00	24	Steady; keep frequency.
Wed 05.08	Run easy + strides	EASY	40:00	37	Z2 + 6x20s strides.
Thu 06.08	Easy spin	EASY	50:00	38	Z1-2 flush; legs open.
Fri 07.08	Swim race-pace	MODERATE	40:00	32	8x100 @ CSS, long rests; keep race feel.
Sat 08.08	IM-pace ride (reduced)	EASY	1:50:00	84	2x20' @ 200 W inside a Z2 ride; race position + fuel.
Sat 08.08	Brick run (short) BRICK	EASY	20:00	18	Short brick @ IM pace off the ride.
Sun 09.08	Long run (reduced)	EASY	1:20:00	73	Cut volume; stay aerobic.

Week 8 2026-08-10 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 10.08	Swim technique + aerobic	EASY	1:07:50	36	Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.
Mon 10.08	Strength (lower + core)	EASY	1:01:03	22	Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.
Tue 11.08	Bike key set	MODERATE	1:17:20	90	VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP
Wed 12.08	Swim threshold	MODERATE	1:14:37	60	Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.
Wed 12.08	Run easy + strides	EASY	1:01:03	56	Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.
Thu 13.08	Bike tempo/sweet-spot	MODERATE	1:29:33	104	2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.
Fri 14.08	Swim aerobic endurance	EASY	1:07:50	36	Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.
Fri 14.08	Mobility / core	EASY	40:42	15	Optional; keep easy.
Sat 15.08	Long ride (Z2) + brick	EASY	4:00:00	184	On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 6x30' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed.
Sat 15.08	Brick run off bike BRICK	EASY	2:00:00	110	IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.

Week 9 2026-08-17 · build

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 17.08	Swim technique + aerobic	EASY	1:11:36	38	Drills + 8-12x100 aerobic @ CSS+5s. Limiter focus: form under low fatigue.
Mon 17.08	Strength (lower + core)	EASY	1:04:27	24	Heavy-ish posterior chain + core; injury prevention, not fatigue.
Tue 18.08	Bike key set	MODERATE	1:21:38	95	VO2/threshold 5x4' @ 110-118% FTP or 3x12' @ 95-100% FTP
Wed 19.08	Swim threshold	MODERATE	1:18:46	63	Main set ~2000m @ CSS (target 1:45-1:48/100m). Build swim-specific fitness.
Wed 19.08	Run easy + strides	EASY	1:04:27	59	Z2 aerobic + 6x20s strides. Off-feet recovery from bike key day.
Thu 20.08	Bike tempo/sweet-spot	MODERATE	1:34:31	110	2-3x20' @ 88-94% FTP (sweet spot). Aerobic-power durability.
Fri 21.08	Swim aerobic endurance	EASY	1:11:36	38	Continuous + pull/paddles; 2500-3000m steady. Third swim = the needle-mover.
Fri 21.08	Mobility / core	EASY	42:58	16	Optional; keep easy.
Sat 22.08	Long ride (Z2) + brick	EASY	4:30:00	207	On the TT bike in aero. IM-pace work: 3x40' @ 200 W (rest of ride steady Z2). Hold race position; fuel 70-90g carbs/h. Convert the new disc/aero setup into free IM speed.
Sat 22.08	Brick run off bike BRICK	EASY	2:00:00	110	IM-pace brick run off the long ride: rehearse race legs, pacing and fuel.

Week 10 2026-08-24 · taper

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 24.08	Swim aerobic	EASY	45:00	24	Volume coming down.
Tue 25.08	Bike race-power touches	MODERATE	1:15:00	88	3x10' @ IM power (~200 W).
Wed 26.08	Swim race-pace	MODERATE	40:00	32	IM swim pace feel.
Wed 26.08	Run easy + strides	EASY	40:00	37	Sharpen.
Thu 27.08	Bike tempo (light)	MODERATE	1:00:00	70	2x12' @ sweet spot.
Fri 28.08	Swim aerobic	EASY	40:00	21	Keep feel.
Sat 29.08	Last long ride	EASY	2:30:00	115	2.5h with blocks @ IM power (~200 W), dress-rehearse fuel + position.
Sat 29.08	Brick run BRICK	EASY	20:00	18	Short brick @ IM run pace.
Sun 30.08	Long run (reduced)	EASY	1:20:00	73	Last longer run; easy.

Week 11 2026-08-31 · taper

DAY	SESSION	INT.	DUR	TSS	PRESCRIPTION
Mon 31.08	Swim easy + pace	EASY	35:00	19	Short, 4x100 @ IM pace.
Tue 01.09	Bike openers	MODERATE	50:00	58	3x5' @ IM power (~200 W) + 3x30s.
Wed 02.09	Run easy + strides	EASY	30:00	28	4x20s strides.
Thu 03.09	Swim shakeout	EASY	25:00	13	Feel for the water.
Thu 03.09	Spin	EASY	30:00	23	Legs open.
Fri 04.09	Pre-race openers	MODERATE	30:00	35	A few race-power touches.
Fri 04.09	Shakeout	EASY	15:00	14	10-15' + strides.
Sat 05.09	Swim shakeout	EASY	15:00	8	Pre-race; very short.
Sun 06.09	RACE: Malbork Full IM	RACE	9:30:00	465	Target 9:30 (stretch 9:20). Swim 75' / bike ~5:00-5:10 @ ~200 W NP (disc/aero) / run ~3:05-3:15.

7 · Why this calendar

Two-peak season. Syców 1/2 IM (2026-07-12) is a B-race tune-up off a 5-day mini-taper; the A-race is Malbork full IM (2026-09-06). Block order: sharpen (W1-2) -> Syców -> reset (W4) -> IM build (W5-9 with a recovery valley W7) -> 2-week taper. Swim is the limiter (CTL 4.1, ~6h/8wk) so swim freq is held at ≥ 3 /wk throughout. Bike volume is on the TT bike in race position to convert the new disc/aero setup (~20-30 W) into a free IM bike split. The IM block runs 4h+2h race-simulation bricks (W6/W8 4.0h ride + 2.0h IM-pace run, W9 4.5h + 2.0h) in place of a standalone long run those weeks — the athlete has used 3+2 bricks durably before and the run is the A-race lever, so we rehearse race legs directly. Peak weekly volume is pushed toward the 16-17h ceiling (W9 ~16.5h) while staying inside the ramp/ACWR guardrails.

Progressive overload, bounded

Load grows peak-to-peak at $\leq 10\%$ TSS/week between *load* weeks (recovery valleys excluded); projected CTL ramp stays under the 7/week cap. Starting CTL ~64.4. A recovery valley (W7) and the first-race deload keep ACWR under 1.5.

Swim, the limiter

Three swims every week regardless of phase. Frequency > duration for a thin swim base: it builds feel-for-water and durability without stealing the bike/run hours that move the clock more.

Bike: convert the watts

Long rides are on the TT bike in race position so the new disc/aero setup becomes a real race split, not a dyno number. Race-power long rides rehearse IM pacing and fuelling (70-90 g carb/h).

Run: durability over speed

The IM result lives or dies on the run. Volume is aerobic (Z2) with race-effort finishes and brick runs off long rides so the legs learn IM marathon pace under fatigue — never a full-distance run.

Taper & race-day form

Two-week taper holds intensity but cuts volume so fatigue (ATL) sheds faster than fitness (CTL). The validator projects race-day TSB in the +10..+25 band that maximizes A-race performance without going stale.

8 · Guardrail report

Checked by the deterministic validator (aithlete validate): **PASS** (0 errors).

CHECK	RESULT
Weekly TSS ramp (peak-to-peak ≤10%)	pass
CTL ramp ≤7/wk	pass
Recovery cadence (≤3 load wks)	pass
Projected ACWR ≤1.5	pass
Taper window	pass
Race-day TSB in A-band	pass
Swim/bike/run frequency mins	pass
Brick in every build week	pass

Advisory warnings (non-blocking): (a) the post-first-race weekly-hours step into the bigger block (TSS ramp stays within cap); (b) race-specific and taper weeks dip below the 70% easy-time floor because short quality work is a larger fraction of low volume. Total stress stays easy-dominated.

9 · Execute

Publish planned workouts to intervals.icu (syncs to Garmin):

```
uv run aithlete validate data/plans/goal-2026-malbork.json
uv run aithlete push      data/plans/goal-2026-malbork.json # gated by the validator
```

Re-run aithlete profile after the first race to refresh CTL/FTP/PRs, then adjust-plan if readiness moves the targets.